

SKITCH GRIP BOODLE

EPISODE 07 —
THE BETTER BUILDING







THE WRENWICK

A RESIDENTIAL COMMUNITY
BUILT ON TRUST. KEPT IN ORDER.

CAUGHT BETWEEN
CIVIC POLITENESS
AND WOUNDED PRIDE.

MM. HMPH.
WE'LL SEE HOW LONG
THAT LASTS.

WELCOME
TO THE
WRENWICK

ELEVATOR
OFFICES
MAIL ROOM
COMMUNITY HALL
ROOFTOP GARDEN

ONE REMARK.
ONE TURNED BACK.

AND JUST LIKE THAT—
THE CHALLENGE
IS ACCEPTED.



THIS BUILDING.
THESE PEOPLE.

THEY THINK
I'M JUST A NEW
CARETAKER.



GOOD.

LET THEM.



I DON'T NEED
RECOGNITION.

I NEED RESULTS.



THE STAIRCASE.

A PATH OF EARNED
RESPECT.



THE ELEVATOR.

A LIFT FOR
THOSE WHO
DESERVE IT.



THE CORRIDOR.

A PLACE OF
ENDLESS
POSSIBILITY.



BLUEPRINT
STANCE!

NOT WITH WORDS.

BUT WITH
EVERY BRICK.
EVERY ACT.
EVERY DAY.

I WILL PROVE
HE WAS WRONG.

LET'S GET TO WORK.

RIVERSIDE TENEMENTS
BOILER ROOM

BEHOLD!

THE HEART
OF OUR HUMBLE
ABODE!

WHERE STEAM
BECOMES COMFORT,
AND PRESSURE
BECOMES
POSSIBILITY!

MM.

EVERYTHING
APPEARS TO BE...
FUNCTIONING.

OBSERVE!

OUR FINEST
GAUGE! SHE FLUTTERS
LIKE A DRUMMER'S
HEART BEFORE A
BIG SOLO!

PSSSSHH!

HMM.

FLUTTERING
IS NOT ON THE
MAINTENANCE
LOG.

AND THIS
VENERABLE
PRESSURE KNOB!

OLDER THAN
THE BUILDING ITSELF!
TURNED BY HAND,
BLESSED BY STEAM!

A LITTLE
WOBBLE ADDS
CHARACTER!

OR IMMINENT
FAILURE.

CLINK
CLINK

CLATTER!

QUICK!
HIDE IT ALL!

TRULY, THIS ROOM
IS A SYMPHONY OF
COPPER AND CONDENSATION!

EACH HISS,
A NOTE.

EACH RATTLE,
A REMINDER THAT
WE THRIVE!

YOU THRIVE.
I MAINTAIN.

IT IS NEAT.
IF OVERWORKED.

AND I SUSPECT
SOMEONE IS
STORING NON-
ESSENTIAL ITEMS
IN A UTILITY
SPACE.

WELCOME TO
THE WONDERFUL,
WOBBLY, WHIRLING
WORLD OF OUR
BOILER ROOM!

APPLAUSE!

I AM GOING TO
NEED STRONGER
GLOVES.

HISSSSS—
KNOCK!
KNOCK!



HM?
FRESH
PAINT.
HOW...
CARELESS.

WAIT! DON'T-
STOP!
DON'T
TOUCH THAT!

WET PAINT!
(VERY WET)



MM.
SO IT
WOULD
SEEM.



Y-YEAH!
I JUST-
YOU KNOW.
LOOKING OUT
A FELLOW
CARETAKER!
SAFETY
FIRST!

YES. THAT.



VERY SLIPPERY!
VERY... UH...
HARD TO CLEAN!

YEAH.
YEAH. STUFF.



WAH!

FWIP!

CLATTER!

I MEAN, LOOK
AT THIS SETUP!
IT'S BASICALLY
A TRAP!

FOR VERY
IMPORTANT
PEOPLE!
LIKE YOU!



IS THAT
SO?

HOW VERY...
CONSIDERATE
OF YOU.



HE KNOWS.
HE TOTALLY
KNOWS.

THIS SMELLS LIKE
FRESH PAINT, OLD
BASEBOARDS, AND
IMPENDING DOOM.

I HATE THIS JOB.

THE VERTICAL BOARDING HOUSE

One building. Infinite scruples.
One fox. Very little time.



Grip, Junior Caretaker
Speed. Discretion.
Duct tape.

RIVAL CARETAKER
IS TWO FLOORS
BELOW ME!

BREATHE,
GRIP. BREATHE.

ONE TINY FIX
AT A TIME!

KLANG...

HM.

LET US
SEE IF OUR
STANDARDS...

...HAVE
SLIPPED.

1F THE LOBBY



SMELLS LIKE:
STEAM & BRASS
PRESSURE:
POLITE & WATCHING

PROBLEM:
CURTAIN
CROOKED.

FIX:
STRAIGHTEN.

FWIP!

HMM!

SNIFF

QUITE
INVITING.

2F THE KITCHEN



SMELLS LIKE:
SOUP & SPICE
PRESSURE:
HOT & STICKY

PROBLEM:
EXTRA CUPS
IN PLAIN SIGHT.

FIX:
CABINET
CONCEALMENT!

SHOVE!

SNIFF

AH.
KITCHEN IS
WELL-MANAGED.

CARRY ON.

3F THE HALLWAY



SMELLS LIKE:
OLD PAPER & POLISH
PRESSURE:
QUIET & JUDGMENTAL

PROBLEM:
SMUDGED SIGN.

FIX:
FLIP!

FLIP!

QUIET
IS CARE

MM.
WELL
SAID.

4F THE ATTIC



SMELLS LIKE:
DUST & OLD WOOD
PRESSURE:
CREAKY & UNSTABLE

PROBLEM:
LOOSE
FLOORBOARD.

FIX:
PRESS &
HOLD!

CREAK...

PRESS!

TAP
TAP

STAIRS
HOLDING.

GOOD.

5F THE GALLERY



SMELLS LIKE:
OIL PAINT & TIME
PRESSURE:
PERFECTIONIST

PROBLEM:
CROOKED
FRAME.

FIX:
JUST A
NOD.

NOD.

AH.
BALANCED.

AS IT
SHOULD BE.

ONE FLOOR
AHEAD!

JUST ONE
MORE!

KLANG...

EVEN THE
DUMBWAITER
IS JUDGING
ME...

TO BE CONTINUED...

HILLSIDE CARETAKER STATION
— AFTERNOON



SCRRRCH!

B-BOODLE?!
WAIT--!



SHUFFLE!



NO! NO, NO,
NOT THERE!



FOLD!



RIVAL CARETAKER
TOUR TODAY
- KEEP STATION
TIDY & SIMPLE!
SMILE. BOW.
DON'T OVER-
EXPLAIN.

FLUTTER...

THAT NOTE—
THE TEAPOT—
THE BLANKET TAG—
EVERYTHING!



HE'LL
KNOW!!



PERFECT FLOW.
CLEAR PATH.
NO CLUTTER.
JUST LIKE PLAN!

THAT IS
NOT THE
PLAN--!

YOU'RE TOO
GOOD AT THIS!!

AHEM.

TO BE CONTINUED...



THE ELDRIDGE
STEWARDSHIP
WING
— LEVEL 3

WELL, WELL,
IF IT ISN'T THE
CARETAKER WHO
ALMOST WAS.

SKITCH.

I EXPECT
PROFESSIONAL
DISTANCE.

::HNNNGH::



OH? DISTANCE?
HOW INTERESTING.

IS THAT
THE SAME DISTANCE
BETWEEN YOUR PRIDE
AND WHAT **ACTUALLY**
HAPPENED OUT
THERE?

WHAM!

THAT WAS AN
UNFORTUNATE
CONFLUENCE OF
CIRCUMSTANCES.

...AND
BAD LUCK.



REALLY? THEN
ENLIGHTEN ME.

HOW DOES ONE
CONFLUENCE THEMSELVES
INTO LOSING TO A
"RAINBOW FLUFFER"?

WAS IT THE
STARDUST? OR THE
HURT FEELINGS?

WATCH
YOUR TONE,
SKITCH.

YOU WALK A
FINE LINE.



OH, I KNOW.

THAT'S WHAT
MAKES IT FUN.

BESIDES...

I'M NOT
LOYAL TO YOU.

I'M LOYAL TO
ENTERTAINMENT.

SEE YOU AROUND,
CARETAKER WHO
COULD'VE BEEN.

♥️

YAAAWN...
FLOORS DON'T
JUDGE...



SKITCH'S NOTES

PRIDE: BRUISED.

ENTERTAINMENT: EXCELLENT.

10/10 WOULD PROVOKE AGAIN. 🐾

THE LAUREL
BOARDING HOUSE
Lobby

IMPRESSIVE
PLACE.

A LOT OF
THOUGHT WENT
INTO IT.

BUT... MY OWN
BUILDING RUNS
EFFORTLESSLY.

TICK.

TICK.

TICK.

WELCOME TO
THE LAUREL
BOARDING HOUSE!

HOUSE RULES

- Be Kind
- Keep It Tidy
- Respect Quiet Hours
- No Late-Night Mischief
- Help One Another Grow

THANK YOU! ♥

EFFORTLESSLY?

IS THAT SO.

CHIME!

ROOM
07

THEN PROVE IT.

MEET ME HERE
AT SIX O'CLOCK
THIS EVENING.

WE'LL SEE WHO
RUNS WHAT
EFFORTLESSLY.

...HM.

VERY WELL.

TICK.

TICK.

TICK.

ROOM
07

CHIME...

WELCOME TO
THE LAUREL
BOARDING HOUSE!

HOUSE RULES

- Be Kind
- Keep It Tidy
- Respect Quiet Hours
- No Late-Night Mischief
- Help One Another Grow

THANK YOU! ♥

**GAME
ON!**



OUT OF CURIOSITY...
WE TAGGED ALONG.

EVERYTHING HERE
WAS PERFECT.
TOO PERFECT.



SPOTLESS.



PRECISE.



IMMACULATE.



AND THEN WE SAW
THE TRUTH.

POLISH
BANISTER...

REFILL
SOAP...

FLOWERS
STRAIGHT...

LAUNDRY...
AGAIN...

CHECK
SUPPLIES...

DAILY DUTIES
Flores & Banks

Polish banister	
Refill soap	
Flowers straight	
Laundry	
Check supplies	
...	

NO ONE
NOTICES.

MORE
COFFEE



EXHAUSTED.
UNSEEN.
HOLDING
EVERYTHING
TOGETHER.



SOME HEROES
DON'T WEAR
CAPES.

WRENWICK
LOBBY
EARLY EVENING



GRIP—
COME HERE.

I NEED TO
SHOW YOU
SOMETHING.



BOODLE AND
I CHECKED OUT
THOSE MAINTENANCE
TUNNELS LIKE YOU
ASKED.

THERE'S
SOMETHING
DOWN THERE.

SOMETHING
THAT DOESN'T
BELONG TO THIS
BUILDING.



OLD POWER.
THE KIND THAT
PREDATES
WRENWICK.

SOMETHING
WOKE UP
RECENTLY.

WE SAW IT.
FELT IT.

BOODLE'S
RUNES PICKED IT
UP CLEAR AS DAY.



I KNOW THIS
ISN'T MY PLACE TO
TELL YOU WHAT TO
DO WITH IT.

JUST FIGURED...
YOU SHOULD
KNOW.

THAT'S ALL.



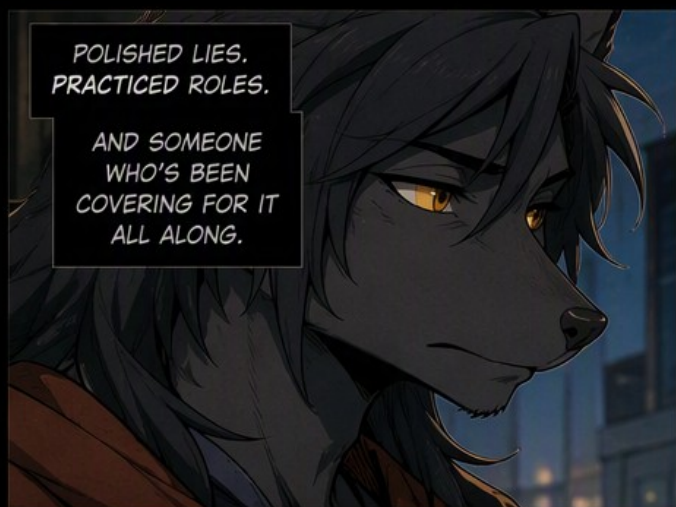
...THANK YOU,
SKITCH.

THAT WAS
THE RIGHT THING
TO DO.

QUIETLY.
WITHOUT EXPECTING
ANYTHING BACK.



SO THAT'S
HOW IT IS.



POLISHED LIES.
PRACTICED ROLES.

AND SOMEONE
WHO'S BEEN
COVERING FOR IT
ALL ALONG.



I COULD
CALL THEM
OUT.



I COULD
WALK AWAY.



OR I COULD
...LET IT
PLAY OUT.



WELL?

YOU'RE
AWFULLY
QUIET.



I-IT'S JUST...
I DIDN'T WANT
TO GET ANYONE
IN TROUBLE...

I WAS JUST
DOING WHAT
THEY ASKED...



TRUTH HAS
A WEIGHT.

HOW YOU CARRY
IT... THAT'S
ON YOU.



AND SO, AS I
ALWAYS SAY, GREAT
CARETAKERS AREN'T
BORN—
THEY'RE **MADE**.



...



THANKS.
...FOR NOTICING.

NOT EVERY VICTORY
NEEDS AN AUDIENCE. 

MOST PASS
WITHOUT A WORD.
THEY DON'T SEE
HIM.

SERVICE
CORRIDOR B
AUTHORIZED
PERSONNEL
ONLY

...

CAUTION
WET FLOOR

HEY.

YOU DO
GOOD WORK
BACK HERE.

...HUH?

M-ME?

YEAH. THIS PLACE
STAYS CLEAN, RUNS
SMOOTH...

MOST FOLKS
DON'T EVEN REALIZE
WHY.

N-NO ONE'S
EVER SAID THAT
TO ME BEFORE.

WELL...

SOMEONE
SHOULD.

THANK YOU...
REALLY.

EVEN SMALL WORDS
CAN BRIGHTEN
THE DARKEST CORNERS.



THE WANDERER'S REST
LOBBY

SOME PLACES
DON'T NEED
TO BE PERFECT.

ROOMS
101-108 →
BATHS →
TEA ROOM →
TRAINING MAT →

REST.
REFOCUS.
RETURN
WHEN READY.

SOME PLACES
JUST NEED TO
BE REAL.



TIME ISN'T
IN A RUSH.

AND THAT'S
MORE THAN
ENOUGH.

THE END.

